CERNO GLOBUS

FIELD INTELLIGENCE

**Issue 006** Wednesday, October 28, 2026 · Biweekly, 4 pages

# Commercial & Facilities

Fire Protection · Paving · Facilities Services · Security Systems · Elevator · Venue & Catering

Six trades, one publication. Every item is something that moves a number on your P&L, changes what you must do by law, or changes what parts and labor cost you.

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BACKGROUND SIGNAL
The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

**Read it online**
This issue, and every one before it

RULE

## Massachusetts' fire prevention board voted to require annual checks for recalled sprinkler heads, with property owners responsible for notifying the fire department and replacing them.

Massachusetts' Board of Fire Prevention Regulations voted on a Thursday, according to a statement from the governor's office reported by FireRescue1 on October 24, to write new requirements into the next edition of the state's Comprehensive Fire Safety Code. Sprinkler systems will have to be checked annually for recalled heads. The edition is expected early next year.

Property owners will have to notify their local fire department if they have recalled equipment and replace it, and local fire departments can require added fire protection until the replacement is done. Under current NFPA standards, owners rather than contractors or inspectors are responsible for finding and replacing recalled heads; the new rules make owners responsible for ensuring the replacement happens.

The update follows the July 2025 fire at Gabriel House, an assisted living residence in Fall River, which killed 10 residents and which FireRescue1 calls Massachusetts' deadliest fire in more than 40 years. Recalled sprinklers contributed to problems during that fire, and a Fall River fire captain pushed for the changes.

The same update bans welding, grinding and other hot work when winds exceed 15 mph and requires hot work safety training to be renewed every three years.

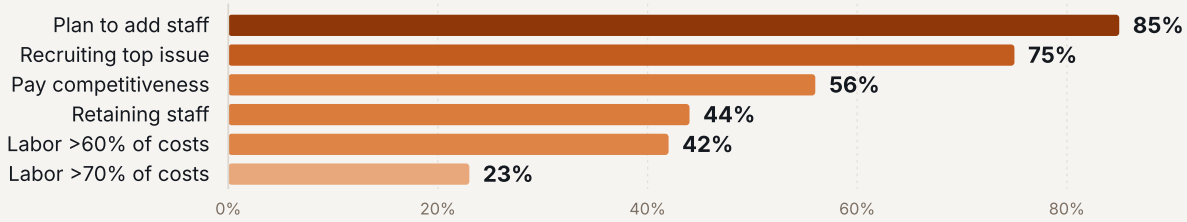
**What to do about it:** Treat recalled sprinkler heads as the owner's problem in every state. This week, list each building you own or service and the make and model of the sprinkler heads in it, and compare them with current recall notices. Ask your sprinkler contractor to report recalled-head findings in the written inspection report, with a quote to replace them. If you run welding or grinding in Massachusetts, schedule it for calm days and log each worker's training date, which now needs renewing every three years. Ask the Board of Fire Prevention Regulations or your local fire department for the effective date before the new code edition arrives early next year.

FireRescue1: Mass. updates fire code (Oct 24)

INFOGRAPHIC 1 / CLEANING LABOR PRESSURE

### Three in four building service contractors name recruiting their top labor challenge, up from 69% last year, and 42% say labor tops 60% of costs.

Percent of building service contractors responding, CMM 2026 Building Service Contractor Benchmarking Survey, article published September 3, 2026.




Recruiting is the top labor challenge for 75%, 6 points above last year's 69%, while 85% plan to add staff. At a 70% labor share, a 5% wage rise adds 3.5% to total cost (0.70 × 5). Write a wage escalator into renewals now, and price the raise needed to fill your longest-open positions. CMM 2026 BSC Benchmarking Survey Report (Sept 3)

## FIRE PROTECTION

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

### Pye-Barker Fire & Safety is buying New Jersey alarm installer Union Alarmtronic, SDM reported October 25; the price and closing date were not disclosed.

**Why it matters:** Mesirow was exclusive financial advisor to Union Alarmtronic, which installs, monitors, maintains and integrates fire alarm, video surveillance, access control and intercom systems for residential and commercial customers. Pye-Barker describes itself as a U.S. provider of fire protection, life safety and security services. If you own a fire or alarm business, pull your recurring-contract list, renewal dates and largest-customer share now. If you buy service from one, ask in writing whether pricing or response times change.

SDM: Mesirow advises Union Alarmtronic sale (Oct 25)

REGULATION

### SDM Magazine's analysis of a Chicago municipal audit, published October 5, says sprinklers met inspection requirements about three-quarters of the time and about one in four facilities lacked proof of maintenance.

**Why it matters:** The article says fire pumps were not far ahead of sprinklers and that recordkeeping violations can carry fines of several hundred dollars up to nearly $2,000 per incident. It also cites industry data that well over half of incidents where sprinklers failed to activate involved systems that had been shut off. The owner carries the paperwork risk: if you cannot produce inspection, test and repair reports on request, the gap alone can draw a fine. This week, ask your sprinkler contractor for one list of every inspection and reinspection due date, and confirm that each report reaches you within days of the visit.

SDM Magazine: the fire protection compliance gap (Oct 5)

## PAVING

TWO ITEMS

REGULATION

### More than 100 organizations, NAPA among them, wrote the Senate on October 13 backing the Bipartisan American Affordability and Jobs Act and its permitting provisions, and 34 Transportation Construction Coalition members followed on October 16.

**Why it matters:** The October 13 coalition letter praises negotiators for practical solutions to permitting challenges that it says will reduce costs and help projects break ground. NAPA's own October 8 letter calls the bill a permitting package that makes the process more efficient and predictable. The October 16 coalition letter urges faster project delivery by modernizing federal reviews without weakening safety or environmental standards. If you bid state or federal work, ask your state asphalt association how faster reviews would change letting schedules, and watch NAPA's letters page for the vote.

NAPA letters page, October 2026 · NAPA: coalition letter to the Senate (Oct 13)

REGULATION

### A federal appeals court vacated EPA's 2024 methylene chloride rule in a ruling dated September 15, which NAPA posted on October 21.

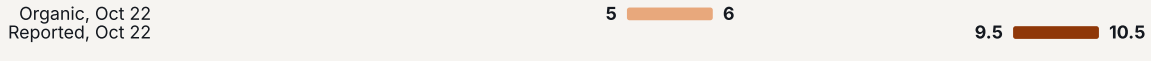
**Why it matters:** In East Fork Enterprises v. EPA the Fifth Circuit found errors of law and unsupported evidence, vacated the rule and its risk determination, and sent the matter back to EPA. NAPA describes the rule as prohibiting most uses of methylene chloride. The 2024 rule had covered manufacture, processing, distribution, commercial use and disposal. If your lab or shop buys solvents, check labels and safety data sheets for methylene chloride, and keep current handling practices until EPA says what comes next.

NAPA news: court strikes down EPA rule (Oct 21) · Fifth Circuit vacates methylene chloride rule (Sept 15)

INFOGRAPHIC 2 / ALLEGION OUTLOOK

### Allegion raised its 2026 organic growth outlook to 5%-6% and its reported growth outlook to 9.5%-10.5% on October 22.

Full-year 2026 revenue growth outlook, percent, low to high, from Allegion's October 22, 2026 earnings release.




Allegion's October 22 release raises its full-year organic growth outlook to 5.0%-6.0% and its reported revenue growth outlook to 9.5%-10.5%. Non-residential was up low-double digits organically on volume growth and price realization. Ask your door-hardware supplier how long its quotes hold before you price spring jobs. Allegion Q3 2026 results release (Oct 22)

## FACILITIES SERVICES

TWO ITEMS

REGULATION

### OSHA's revised Hazard Communication Standard is scheduled to take effect by November 20, 2026, CleanLink reported October 20, changing chemical classification terms, small-container labels and the combustible dust definition.

**Why it matters:** CleanLink says the update changes how concentrations are communicated, narrows the downstream-use duty to known or reasonably anticipated uses, and sets a tiered compliance schedule. It says commercial cleaning companies will have to review documentation procedures. Before November 20, pull your written hazard communication program, safety data sheet binder and labels on spray bottles and other small containers. Ask each chemical supplier in writing when reissued labels and sheets will ship, and confirm the tier dates with OSHA.

CleanLink: countdown to OSHA HazCom compliance (Oct 20)

MONEY

### BSCAI's October 13 guide to leasing autonomous cleaning equipment tells contractors to run a real trial in their own facility, read the lease terms and review results at 90 days.

**Why it matters:** The guide says a $50,000 machine can take years to earn back, so compare the monthly payment with the paid labor hours it reliably frees. Its example is a 500,000-square-foot building where only 80,000 square feet, 16%, can be cleaned unsupervised, and a machine whose nightly use fell from six hours to four, then three. Check term, buyout, usage caps, early-termination penalties and whether service, parts and batteries are included. Before signing, run a trial with your own crew and set a 90-day decision date in writing.

BSCAI: 10 rules for leasing autonomous equipment (Oct 13)

## SECURITY SYSTEMS

TWO ITEMS

SUPPLY

### Reuters reported October 16 that SoftBank is in preliminary talks to buy guard company Allied Universal, a deal it said could value Allied at about $18 billion.

**Why it matters:** No binding agreement has been announced, SoftBank declined to comment, and Allied said it does not comment on rumors. IPVM, relayed by SecurityInfoWatch on October 19, puts equity value at up to $18 billion plus about $12 billion of public debt, and says Allied employs approximately 800,000 guards and serves more than 400 Fortune 500 companies. If Allied or a subcontractor guards your site, pull the agreement this week, find the assignment, change-of-control, termination and rate-adjustment clauses, and ask your account manager in writing to give notice of any ownership change.

SecurityInfoWatch: SoftBank-Allied talks (Oct 19)

REGULATION

### A legal brief posted October 16 lists license-plate-reader retention limits by state: Virginia purges non-investigative data after 21 days, Minnesota requires destruction within 60 and Kentucky within 90.

**Why it matters:** The brief also lists Maine and Washington at 21 days, Vermont at an 18-month cap, and Minnesota audits every two years. It says Virginia vendors must certify their systems destroy data irretrievably, and that keeping data past the window exposes the provider to significant liability. If you install or run plate readers, map each jurisdiction you serve and set automatic purge at the shortest period. Put data ownership, retention, sharing and subpoena notice in every contract, and ask counsel whether each statute reaches private lots.

SecurityInfoWatch: ALPR legal risks (Oct 16)

## ELEVATOR

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

### Schindler's nine-month report on October 22 says third-quarter modernization orders fell more than 10% in the Americas while growing more than 10% in every other region.

**Why it matters:** Nine-month order intake was CHF 8.74 billion, up 5.2% in local currencies, with third-quarter orders up 10.3%. New-installation orders rose 15.9%, ahead of expectations, and service grew only slightly. Schindler raised its 2026 EBIT margin target to about 13.5% from about 13.0%. If a modernization proposal is sitting on your desk, get at least one competing bid and ask for a written price hold of 90 days.

Moneycab: Schindler nine-month results (Oct 22)

MONEY

### North Carolina's elevator bureau told elevator companies in a memo dated July 31 that new fees took effect August 14, including $206 for an annual inspection under 10 floors and $309 for 10 or more.

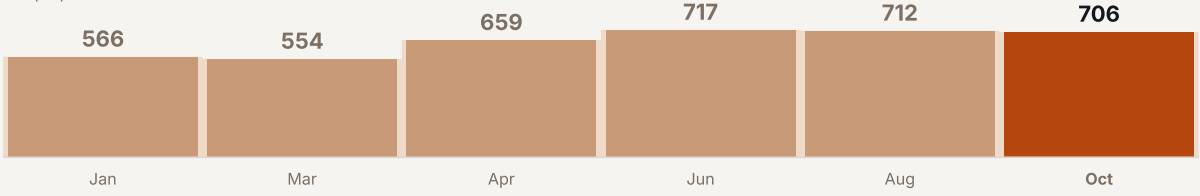
**Why it matters:** Escalator and moving-walk inspections are $515, wheelchair lift and dumbwaiter inspections $103, expedited special inspections $1,031, and a first reinspection after a failed new or alteration inspection $515, then $1,031. The permit application fee is $200 or 1% of the contract price, whichever is greater, so 1% governs above $20,000: $4,000 on a $400,000 modernization. Re-price any North Carolina bid written before August 14, put permit and reinspection fees on their own line, and tell customers a failed final inspection costs at least $515.

NC Labor memo: updated permit and inspection fees

INFOGRAPHIC 3 / LOUISIANA ASPHALT INDEX

### Louisiana's asphalt cement index jumped $105 a ton in April, peaked at $717 in June and stood at $706 on October 1.

Louisiana DOTD asphalt cement price index, PG 64-22, dollars per ton, selected months listed by first-of-month date; latest row is 10/01/2026.




The October 1 reading is unchanged from September and $11 below the June and July peak of $717, down 1.5%, but $140 above January, up 24.7%. The climb has stopped and slipped slightly. If you bid state work, check whether your contract adjusts for asphalt cement and which month sets the index; if it does not, price today's level into bids that run into spring. Louisiana DOTD asphalt cement price indices

## VENUE & CATERING

TWO ITEMS

SUPPLY

### USDA's Animal and Plant Health Inspection Service proposed on October 20 to cut the minimum maturation temperature for boneless beef from foot-and-mouth-affected South American regions from 4 degrees C to 2 degrees C, with comments due December 21.

**Why it matters:** The change would apply to listed regions of Argentina, Brazil, Paraguay and Uruguay and align U.S. rules with the World Organization for Animal Health standard. APHIS says it would not grant new market access and is unlikely to significantly increase imports; its analysis assumed a hypothetical 500 to 5,000 additional metric tons of beef. Ask your distributor where its imported beef originates, and file a comment by December 21 if you buy South American product.

Federal Register: beef maturation temperature (Oct 20)

REGULATION

### Restaurant Dive's October 23 analysis says California's SB 68 has required chains with 20 or more U.S. locations since July 1 to tell guests in writing which of nine major allergens are in each menu item.

**Why it matters:** The piece, by a food-safety executive at a food-safety company, notes that the 2026 FDA Food Code, released September 17, also calls for written notice of major allergens in unpackaged food, and that other states have their own allergen rules. It advises building one standard that meets the strictest state you serve, over six to 12 months. If you cater or run a multi-state kitchen, list every allergen in each menu item and package, and ask your state health department which Food Code edition it enforces.

Restaurant Dive: allergen labeling problem (Oct 23)

THE BACKGROUND SIGNAL

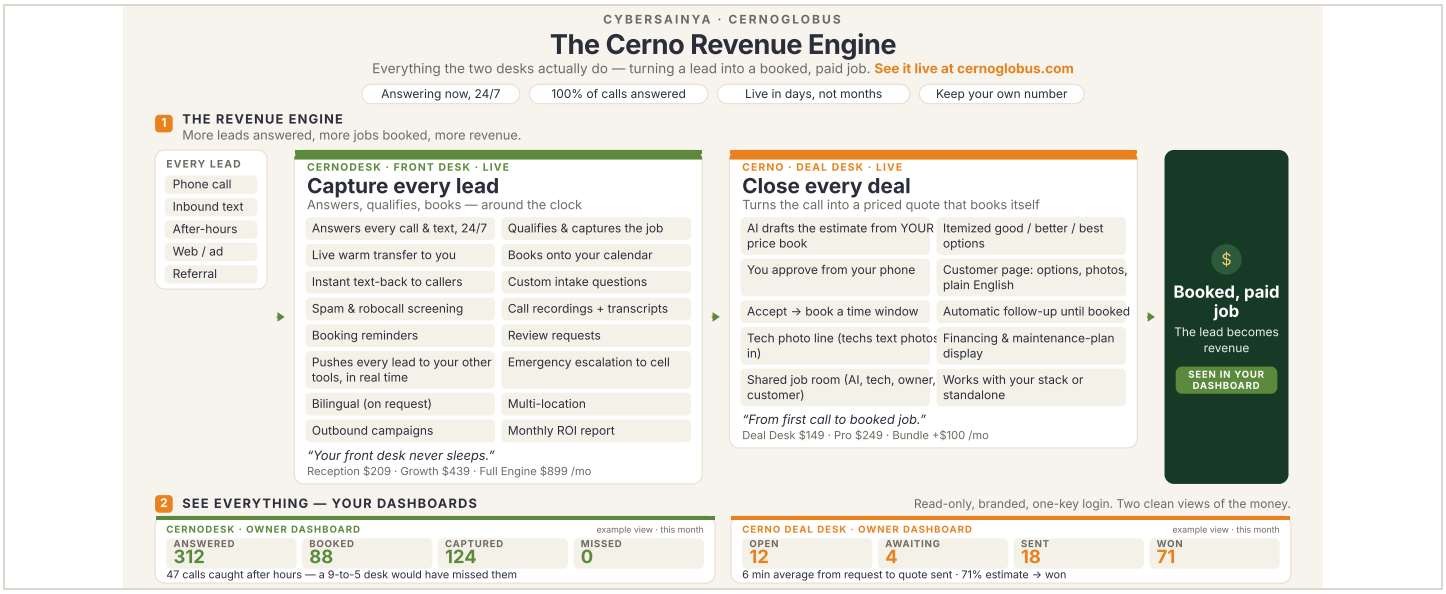
## The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center took 24,768 business email compromise reports in 2025, with losses of $3.05 billion — a record, after dipping to $2.77 billion in 2024 from $2.95 billion in 2023. Across all internet crime it logged 1,008,597 complaints and $20.88 billion in losses. Reported cases only, so read it as a floor.

Business email compromise, not ransomware, is the one that should concern a commercial contractor. Someone gets into a mailbox, reads until they understand how you invoice and who pays you, then sends a real-looking progress billing with different bank details. No malware, no warning — just a payment that never arrives and an argument about who eats it. A trade that emails proposals, work orders and vendor invoices all day is the shape this is built for. The quieter number is adoption: under 20% of firms with fewer than 20 staff use AI at all.

**What to do about it:** You don't need a security program. You need multi-factor authentication on email and your accounting login, and one rule everybody follows: nobody changes bank details on the strength of an email or a call — you ring the number you already had on file and confirm. That covers most of it, and costs nothing. The part it doesn't — how the systems are set up — is the day job of our parent company, CyberSainya.

FBI Internet Crime Complaint Center, 2025 Internet Crime Report — reported cases only, rounded from $2,946,830,270, $2,770,151,146 and $3,046,598,558. U.S. Census Bureau, Business Trends and Outlook Survey, May 3, 2026.




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